



Dream start: Newly promoted Mohammedan Sporting secured its first-ever win in the Indian Super League, beating Chennaiyin FC 1-0. FSDL/ISL MEDIA

SPORTING DELIVERS IN CHENNAIYIN'S DEN

The Black Panthers hunt down their **first prey** in the ISL to continue Chennaiyin FC's jinx at home.

Chennaiyin FC had started its Indian Super League (ISL) 2024-25 season with a 3-2 away win against Odisha on September 14.

So, naturally, when the team bus arrived at Chennai's Jawaharlal Nehru Stadium for its first home game against Mohammedan Sporting nearly two weeks later, thousands of fans laid out a metaphorical red carpet with blue and yellow flares as players and the coach greeted them with smiles.

On a windy evening along the southern coast, the heart of the Marina Machans beat as one — some fans perched on the shoulders of their fathers, some holding hands with loved ones, and others waving flags and scarves — all chanting "Chennaiyin! Chennaiyin!"

"After the comeback last season, we are expecting more this time because Owen (Coyle, Chennaiyin's head coach) will always deliver," said Navneet, a local club fan, proudly donning Chennaiyin's jersey and holding its scarf. "Among the players, we're expecting Farukh

Choudhary to shine, and there's (Lukas) Brambilla, who's just come in, and we hope he can perform like (Rafael) Crivellaro."

Mohammedan, on the other hand, had come under the pressure of being newly promoted and winless after two games, with its backs against the wall.

Chennaiyin's fans made sure to keep that pressure on, unfurling a TIFO inspired by Turkish Olympian Yusuf Dikec that read 'Locked, Loaded, and Ready'.

The match began with Coyle's boys raining attacks on the visitors, with